CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Master Negotiation Course Handbook

"Win better deals, raise your rates, and keep the relationship."



Business Strategy & Deal-Making Track | 6 Weeks | All Levels Self-Paced Study Edition

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Course Foreword



Every extra shilling you earn in your life will pass through a negotiation, a salary, a price, a deadline, a partnership. Yet almost nobody is taught how to do it. That is a gift to you, because a little skill here puts you ahead of nearly everyone you will ever sit across from.

Forget the image of the aggressive shark. The best negotiators are calm, curious and prepared. They listen more than they talk. They make the other side feel safe, then guide the deal toward a place that works for both. This book teaches that quieter, stronger way.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to prepare like a professional, ask for more without fear, handle 'no', and close agreements both sides are glad to sign, skills that pay for the rest of your life.

Do the exercises with real stakes, your actual rates, a real purchase, a real ask at work. Practice on things that matter is the only kind that sticks.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

The mindset that wins before you speak: Grow the pie before you split it.

02

Anchoring and framing: The first justified number anchors the deal.

03

Handle 'no' and pushback calmly: 'No' usually means 'not yet, not like this'.

04

Close win-win agreements: Practice with real stakes whenever you can.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Master Negotiation, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: The mindset that wins before you speak | Module 2: Preparation is 80% of the win



1.1 The mindset that wins before you speak

Weak negotiators believe there is a fixed pie and every gain for the other side is a loss for them. Strong negotiators look for the bigger pie, trades where each side gives what is cheap for them and gets what is valuable to them. A client may not have more cash but can offer a testimonial, a referral, or a longer contract. Money is only one currency.

The second shift is emotional: you must be willing to walk away. The moment you need this deal more than the other side, you have handed them the power. Decide your walk-away point before you start, and the fear that usually controls you loses its grip.

Real-World Example: A designer could not get a client past a low budget. Instead of dropping his price, he traded: full fee, but paid over three months, plus a written referral to two other businesses. Same money for the client's cash flow, two new clients for him. Bigger pie.

Hands-On Practice: For your next deal, list three things you value that cost the other side little (a referral, a review, flexible timing, repeat work). Plan to ask for those if they cannot move on price.

Core Takeaways: Grow the pie before you split it. • Money is one of many currencies. • Whoever can walk away holds the power.

1.2 Preparation is 80% of the win

Deals are usually decided before the conversation starts, by whoever prepared better. Three numbers to know before you speak: your target (what you truly want), your walk-away (the worst you will accept), and your opening (higher than target, so you have room to move). Write them down. Never enter a real negotiation without these three.

Then research the other side. What do they need, what pressures them, what is this worth to them? Knowing that a client just landed a big contract, or that a landlord has had an empty unit for months, is not luck, it is homework. Information is leverage, and leverage is quietly built beforehand.

01

Practitioner Case

Renting a workspace, one founder learned the unit had sat empty for four months. That single fact, the landlord's pain, let her negotiate two free months. She did not out-argue him; she out-prepared him.

02

Action Drill

Before your next negotiation, write your target, walk-away and opening numbers, plus three things you know about the other side's situation. Do not skip the writing.

03

Key Standard

Know your target, walk-away and opening. Open higher than your target to leave room. Information about their pressure is your leverage.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Anchoring and framing | Module 4: Tactical empathy, listen your way to yes

2.1 Anchoring and framing

The first real number spoken pulls the whole conversation toward it, this is anchoring. If you have done your homework, going first with a confident, justified number sets the frame. If you are unsure of the range, let them anchor, then adjust hard. Either way, an anchor is only powerful when it comes with a reason.

Framing decides how a number feels. 'It is 500,000' lands differently than 'It is 500,000, which is about the cost of one lost customer a month, and this stops that.' Same price, different meaning. Always attach your number to the value it protects or creates, not to your costs.

Core Principle

The first justified number anchors the deal.

Field Case Study

A freelancer stopped saying 'I charge 300k'. He started saying 'Websites like this bring in far more than they cost; this one is 300k.' His close rate rose, not because of the number, but because of the frame around it.

Applied Exercise

Write your price or ask, then write one sentence of value to say immediately after it. Never state a number naked again.

Mastery Check

A number without a reason is weak. • Frame price against value, not against your costs.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1	Prepare & Frame The first justified number anchors the deal.	Practice Focus Audit your current approach before acting.
Step 2	Execute Deliberately A number without a reason is weak.	Practice Focus Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.
Step 3	Review & Refine Frame price against value, not against your costs.	Practice Focus Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Tactical empathy - listen your way to yes

Counter-intuitively, the person who listens most usually controls the negotiation. When you accurately name the other side's position, 'It sounds like your worry is going over budget this quarter', they relax, correct you if needed, and reveal what they really care about. You cannot solve a need you have not uncovered.

Ask open questions that start with 'how' and 'what', not 'why' (which sounds like an attack). 'What would need to be true for this to work for you?' invites them to design a deal you can both accept. People defend their own ideas far more than yours, so lead them to say your solution first.

01

Naming their concern lowers their guard.

02

Use 'what' and 'how', avoid 'why'.

03

Guide them to propose your solution themselves.

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

A supplier kept refusing a discount. The buyer stopped pushing and asked, 'What makes this hard on your side?' The real issue was payment timing, not price. They agreed on faster payment for a better rate. Listening found the deal arguing had hidden.

Your Practical Assignment

In your next negotiation, before making any offer, ask two 'what' or 'how' questions and simply listen. Write down what you learn about their real need.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Naming their concern lowers their guard. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: Handle 'no' and pushback calmly | Module 6: Money talks, salary, rates and deals

3.1 Handle 'no' and pushback calmly

'No' is rarely the end, it is usually 'not like this, not yet.' When you hear it, do not panic or cave. Stay curious: 'I understand. Help me see what is not working.' Most objections are really questions in disguise, about risk, budget, or trust. Answer the real concern and the 'no' often softens.

Never negotiate against yourself. Beginners hear silence or a frown and immediately drop their price before the other side has even countered. Make your offer, then stop talking. Let the silence do its work. If they push, trade rather than concede: 'I can do that price if we extend to six months.' Every give should get.



Case: A client said 'too expensive.' Instead of discounting, the freelancer asked, 'Compared to what?' The client admitted the budget was fine but feared missing the deadline. They added a milestone plan, and the deal closed at full price.

Action Drill: Write the three objections you hear most. For each, write a calm question that uncovers the real concern, plus a trade you could offer instead of a discount.

3.2 Money talks - salary, rates and deals

The scariest negotiation for most people is about their own worth. The rule: state your number clearly, then be quiet. Do not apologise, do not laugh nervously, do not immediately offer to lower it. 'For this scope, my rate is X.' Full stop. The discomfort you feel in the silence is normal, sit in it.

When raising rates with existing clients, lead with results, not needs. Nobody pays more because your rent went up; they pay more because you deliver value. 'Over the last months this brought you Y; going forward my rate will be X' ties the increase to what they gained. Give notice, be calm, and be ready to walk if it is truly below your floor.



Case: A social media manager charging 150k realised her client's sales had doubled from her work. She said, 'The account has grown a lot; from next month my rate is 300k.' The client agreed in a day, because she had priced the result, not her time.

Action Drill: Write your rate or salary ask as one clean sentence with no apology. Say it out loud ten times until the silence after it stops scaring you.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Close win-win agreements | Module 8: Your live negotiation simulation

4.1 Close win-win agreements

A deal is not done when you shake hands, it is done when the terms are clear and written. Vague agreements rot into disputes. Before you celebrate, confirm the specifics: what, how much, by when, and what happens if things change. Summarise it back: 'So we agreed on X for Y, delivered by Z, correct?' Then put it in writing, even a simple message.

Aim for a deal the other side is glad they made, not one they feel tricked into. The best negotiators are not the ones who win once; they are the ones people want to deal with again. A slightly smaller win today that builds a five-year relationship beats a crushing win that burns the bridge.

Field Example: Two founders agreed a partnership verbally over tea and later fell out over who owed what. A one-page written summary, roles, money, timeline, would have saved the friendship and the business. Always write it down. | Drill: After your next agreement, send a short written summary: what, how much, by when, and next steps. Ask them to confirm. Make this a lifelong habit.

4.2 Your live negotiation simulation (Capstone)

Skill comes from reps, not reading. Set up a real practice negotiation, a mock salary talk, a price negotiation with a friend playing a tough buyer, or a genuine purchase you are about to make. Prepare properly using your three numbers and your research. Then run it, and afterwards debrief honestly.

In the debrief, ask three questions: Where did I feel fear and what did I do? Where did I talk when I should have listened? What would I trade differently next time? Every negotiation you review teaches you more than ten you simply survive. Keep a small log of deals and lessons, it becomes your edge.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	Confirm specifics before you celebrate.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	Practice with real stakes whenever you can.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Run one real or realistic negotiation this week. Prepare your three numbers, research the other side, and afterwards write your three debrief answers. Repeat monthly.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	Reviewed reps, not luck, build mastery.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

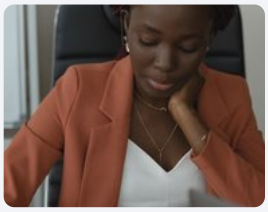
Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Master Negotiation from Module 1 to your final project:

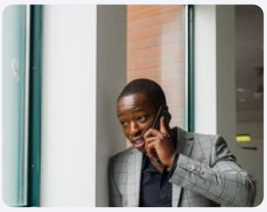
Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	The mindset that wins before you speak	Grow the pie before you split it.
Module 02	Preparation is 80% of the win	Know your target, walk-away and opening.
Module 03	Anchoring and framing	The first justified number anchors the deal.
Module 04	Tactical empathy, listen your way to yes	Naming their concern lowers their guard.
Module 05	Handle 'no' and pushback calmly	'No' usually means 'not yet, not like this'.
Module 06	Money talks, salary, rates and deals	State your number, then stop talking.
Module 07	Close win-win agreements	Confirm specifics before you celebrate.
Module 08	Your live negotiation simulation	Practice with real stakes whenever you can.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"A designer could not get a client past a low budget. Instead of dropping his price, he traded: full fee, but paid over three months, plus a written referral to two other businesses. Same money for the client's cash flow, two new clients for him. Bigger pie."

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"A learner practised a rent negotiation with a classmate first. In the real one, the landlord used the exact objection she had rehearsed. She stayed calm, traded a longer lease for a lower rate, and saved real money, because she had already been there once."

CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Master Negotiation is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Master Negotiation.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Run one real or realistic negotiation this week. Prepare your three numbers, research the other side, and afterwards write your three debrief answers. Repeat monthly.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

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Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

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Official Course E-Book for Master Negotiation (Business Strategy & Deal-Making Track).
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